



FISH

The very first vertebrates (animals with backbones) to evolve were fish.



AMPHIBIANS

Like frogs today, prehistoric amphibians could breathe air but bred in fresh water.



REPTILES

The earliest reptiles evolved from amphibians about 315 million years ago. They had scaly skin.



MAMMALS

The first mammals appeared on Earth about 220 million years ago.

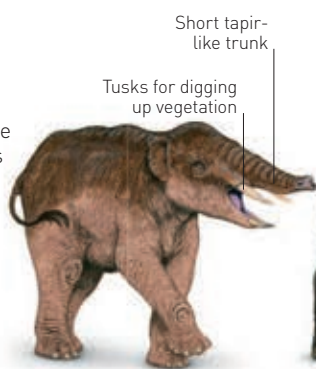
TRANSITION TO MODERN ANIMALS

About 65 million years ago a huge catastrophe wiped out many prehistoric creatures. Birds and some animals survived. Later, new animals emerged, including the ancestors of the mammals we know today.



MOERITHERIUM

This pig-sized relative of the elephant family lived in African swamps and woodlands more than 35 million years ago.



PHIOMIA

Appeared around 35 million years ago. Like modern elephants, it had air-filled spaces in its skull to reduce its weight.



DEINOTHERIUM

Standing 4.5 m (14.8 ft) high, *Deinotherium* roamed Africa, Asia, and Europe around 24 million years ago.



ELEPHANT

The modern elephant, the largest living land animal, has features in common with its prehistoric ancestors, including its trunk.



PROTOSUCHUS



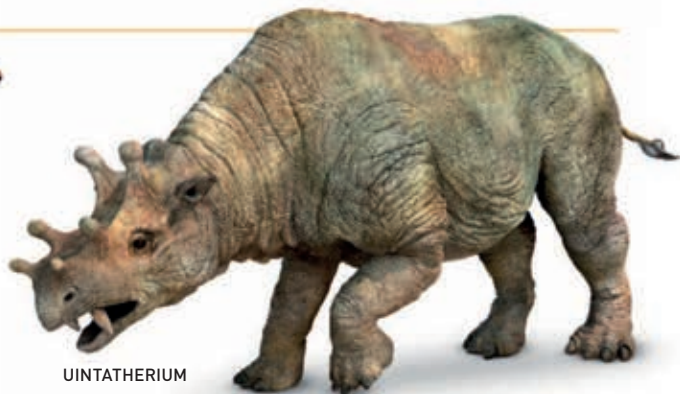
SPHENOSUCHUS



PLIOHIPPIUS



NEMEGTBAATAR



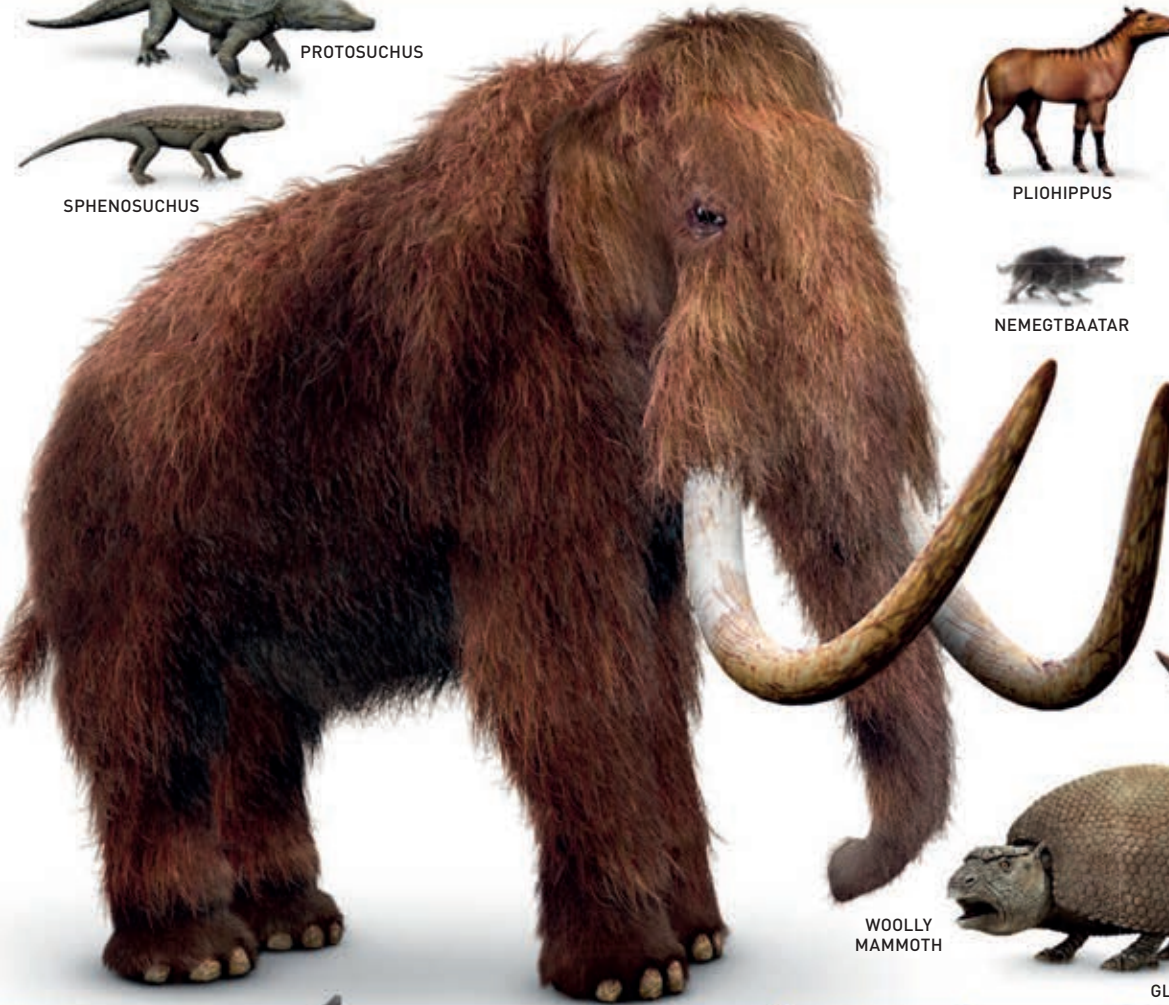
UINTATHERIUM



DIRE WOLF



SMILODON



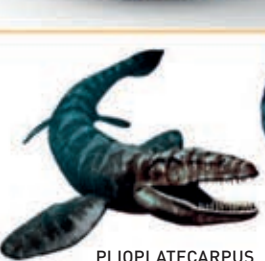
WOOLLY MAMMOTH



GLYPTODON



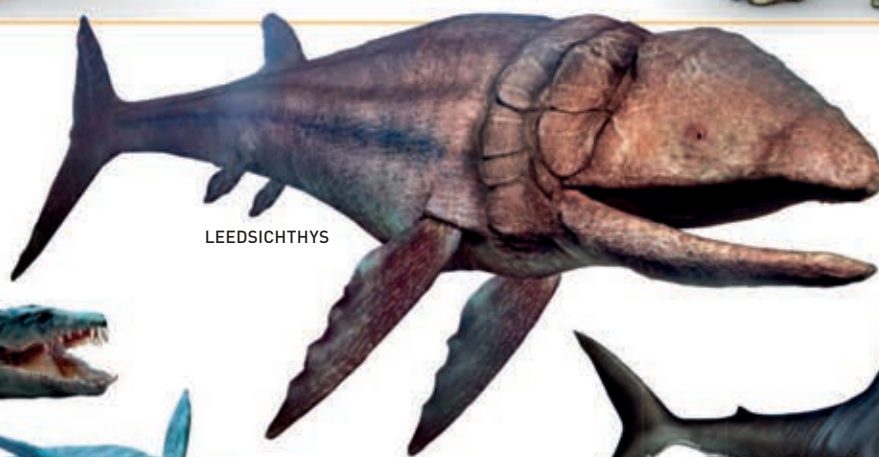
WOOLLY RHINOCEROS



PLIOPATECARPUS



HYBODUS



LEEDSICHTHYS



ISCHYODUS



KRONOSAURUS



MOSASAURUS



ELASMOAURUS



MEGALODON